

Teaching Statement

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In this document, I share my teaching philosophy, courses I taught at Pratt, and workshops I ran since I joined Pratt in Fall 2023.

Teaching Philosophy

My teaching philosophy is inspired by studio pedagogy, virtue ethics, and feminist values^[1]. Building on my diverse educational and work experiences, I am committed to active learning and transformative pedagogies, including design studio practices that allow me to engage students in collaborative projects that build their capacity as learners and value reflexive practice and socially responsible ways of designing. These are some ways I activate my teaching philosophy and apply currently in my teaching practice:

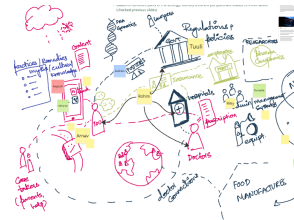
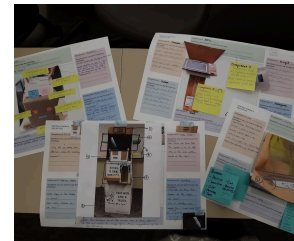
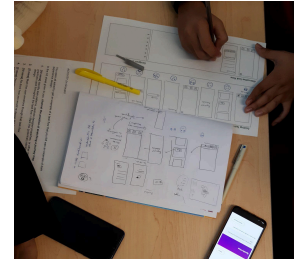
- ◆ **Student Agency and Empowerment:** I encourage co-creating knowledge in the classroom with students allowing them to build on their lived experiences and previous knowledge base. I provide avenues for students to share the co-created knowledge to also build a sense of community of knowledge (for example, in class content creation and “Presentation and Facilitation” exercises during INFO601 class). I do this to encourage students as their own bodies of knowledge and facilitate the process;
- ◆ **Pluralistic Engagements:** I will develop my curriculum to provide students with a mix of both theoretical (e.g., academic readings, book chapters) and practical (e.g., projects, hands-on assignments, reflections) knowledge. I engage students in elements of surprise during their course time through multiple forms of informal (such as gallery walks, desk critiques) and formal (such as project documentation comments, prototype feedback annotations). I mostly engage in a range of submission types for students to have individual and group working environments;
- ◆ **Values-focused Reflection and Critique:** I challenge students to think about the manipulative and persuasive intentions embedded in their work and the political nature of technological artifacts being created, to build a more *socially responsible design character*. I have also proposed and designed a specific course titled “Deceptive Design and Ethical UX” as



[1] Chivukula, S. S. (2020). Feminisms through design: a practical guide to implement and extend feminism: position. Interactions, 27(6), 36–39. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3427338>

inspired from research work.

- ◆ **Adaptive Pedagogies:** I engage (more like, play) with pedagogical styles and tools based on the courses learning objectives and goals. For instance, I have deeply built on *transformative pedagogical* frameworks (“creates critical consciousness, agency, and change in the learner”; teaching inwards) while designing and teaching INFO697–Deceptive Design and Ethical UX; whereas employed a client-based project learning in INFO624–Service Design which would not be a choice for other courses I designed and taught. Adaptive Pedagogies change the teaching style, tools used in class, kinds of assignments for student outcomes, and rhythms in class.
- ◆ **Practice Alignment:** I improve course curriculum to match the technological advancement in the market and allow students to prepare for industrial experience in a classroom setting; especially in my classes dealing with emerging technologies (i.e., INFO636–Conversational UX Design). I build project prompts inspired by tech industry projects, promote using prototyping tools used in industry (Voiceflow, Figma, XD, Protocie);
- ◆ **Student Involvement into Pedagogy Decisions:** I open the space for students to involve in deciding elements (within the given framework) of their learning for the day or in the entire curriculum. I engage with students to reflect and assess learning objectives as a group in the classroom.



I would like to invite the readers to see *behind the scenes* and elements I think about while designing for teaching here: <https://shruthichivukula.com/educator/#elementsofteaching> ↗

In the rest of the document, I share the courses I taught at Pratt since I joined in Fall 2023, workshops I conducted in School of Information, and summary of course evaluation and student feedback based on the above listed philosophy and pedagogical techniques.

Courses taught at Pratt

Here are a list of courses I taught in the School of Information since Fall 2023:

Semesters Taught	Course Name
SU'25	INFO 697–Deceptive Design and Ethical UX This course will teach students the balancing user needs and values with business goals and objectives, which can often be contradictory. From dark patterns to deceptive and manipulative design, this course will challenge students to engage thoughtfully with issues related to design ethics and values. At the conclusion of the course, students will have a foundation of knowledge and awareness to build their own ethical responsibility and action as technology and design practitioners.
FA & SP'25	INFO 624– Service Design This course will teach students the relationship and intersection of information, experience, service, and design. Students use hands-on mapping techniques, co-design, and other participatory approaches to develop and implement service blueprints, ecosystem loops, design interventions, and dynamic personas to design for both front stage and back stage.
SP'25 FA, SU, & SP'24	INFO 636– Conversational User Experience Design [E.g. Syllabus [↗]] This course will teach students topics related to designing, evaluating, and prototyping for conversational user experience (CUX) and interfaces (CUIs). Students will learn the state of the art and science of conversation design, explore the conversational design process, prototyping tools like Voiceflow, and reflect on the ethical implications of designing conversational agents.
FA & SP'25 FA & SP'24 FA'23	INFO 643– Information Architecture and Interaction Design [E.g. Syllabus [↗]] This course provides students with practical knowledge and hands-on experience designing digital interfaces from a user-centered perspective through an exploration of the dual practices of information architecture and interaction design. <i>**Core Course in Masters IxD program @Pratt.</i>
FA'25 FA'24 FA'23	INFO 601– Foundations of Information [Syllabus [↗]] This foundational course focuses on the intersection of people, information, and technology and the theoretical and conceptual foundations of the information field. Students will be introduced to ideas and concepts that will inform future specializations in their course of study and provide them with concrete strategies for ongoing professional growth and development in their area of interest. <i>**Core Course in Masters IxD program @Pratt.</i>

You can refer to the syllabus and project prompts[↗] of all the courses in the attached material.

Workshops and Guest Lectures at SI

I have conducted two workshops for students of SI. In my workshops, I aim to provide hands-on, exploratory learning experiences that expand students' creative and technical skillsets. In *"Mind-Tickle: Ideating UX Design Concepts"* (Spring 2024), students practiced brainstorming and iterating on UX design concepts, learning to generate and refine ideas within a defined design frame. In *'Micro:Bit'e Computing* (Fall 2023), students engaged with physical computing through micro:bit devices, making digital prototyping approachable, playful, and practical. I have also conducted a guest lecture/workshop in INFO696- Advanced Projects in Data Visualization, by invitation from Prof. John Lauermann to introduce user testing methods in the context of data visualization and related products in Spring 2024 and 2025.

Mentoring and Advising

As a faculty advisor, I had 39 advisees in Fall 2024, 21 in Spring 2024, and 34 in Spring 2025 from the IxD program. I meet students on a weekly basis regarding their projects, career trajectories, industry applications, and reference/recommendation letters; outside my class office hours. I also had additional students who are not my advisees from classes reached to me for research interests and career advice.

I mentor three research graduate assistants as a part of the [Translate research group](#) at Pratt and three doctoral students as part of the [UXP²lab](#) at Indiana University, Bloomington. I mentor them through qualitative research data collection, analysis, writing, and general knowledge about the academic research community. I have collaborated with these students on a couple of my publications, nurturing and engaging them throughout the research process to make research fun and creative.

I have acted and advised a doctoral student, (now) Dr. Thomas Mildner from University of Bremen-Germany, as an external dissertation committee. Additionally, I mentored two graduate students in Purdue University through their Master's thesis, helping them in qualitative research design, analysis, and thesis writing.

Future Work

In the future semesters, I plan to continue similar teaching engagements and improve my courses based on regular course evaluations. I also plan to propose new courses in the upcoming semesters, mostly Spring 2026 and onwards, in Wearable UX design and Game design. I am also looking forward to contributing to any curriculum and teaching advancements as a part of the IxD program being a part of the program committee and Curriculum Committee.

[SUMMARY] Course Evaluations and Student Feedback

I have attached course evaluation results as evidence of teaching effectiveness on Interfolio[™].

Here, I would like to summarize my course evaluations (for a quick read). I have taught 12 sections across 5 different courses across Fall, Spring, and Summer 2023–25 semesters.

Students had a positive response for knowing subject matter thoroughly (m>3.8) and presenting in class (m>3.6), utilizing class time well (m>3.7), and recommending my class to other students (m>3.6).

Students have consistently praised my teaching for creating an engaging, interactive, and thoughtfully structured learning environment that helps students grapple complex topics. A comment from student evaluations read: *“Shruthi does such a good job of relating what we are learning to real world application. She brings previous experiences into class that give insight into what this work would look like in industry and I think it is really inspiring to hear from her on her past experiences and also the way she explains concepts. I would 10/10 recommend her as a professor and also this class as a course to other students contemplating taking it.”* Students highlighted my ability to blend real-world insights, dynamic activities, and personalized feedback which makes my teaching style both accessible and “inspiring.” A student’s comment said: *“Love learning with Prof. Chivukula, I have definitely come to enjoy learning new topics because of the way she structures her classes! It really showed me that studying/learning doesn’t need to be a “task”. It can be enjoyed :)”* Students also particularly appreciated my humor, “being funny,” approachable, and responsiveness to address their questions inside and outside class hours. A student shared: *“Professor Chivukula is very professional yet friendly! I love her straightforward design critiques and I appreciate her teaching style and dedication.”*